

Ricardo Benavides

Data Architect & Data Engineering SAP Leader

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CORE COMPETENCIES

Strategy & Leadership

- Team leadership
- Project management
- Data governance
- Cost optimization
- Business-IT alignment

SAP Architecture & Platforms

- BW/4HANA
- SAP Analytics Cloud
- BPC
- BusinessObjects
- Data Intelligence
- Analysis for Office
- ABAP

Advanced Analytics & Cloud

- Databricks
- Databricks AI/BI Genie
- Microsoft Azure
- Data products
- Generative AI & NLP
- Prescriptive intelligence
- Data modeling
- Executive dashboards

LANGUAGES

- SpanishNative
- EnglishIntermediate

CERTIFICATION

SAP NetWeaver 2004s — Business Intelligence
SAP · 2008 · ID 0006064683

EDUCATION

B.Sc. in Computer Science (IT)
Universidad Autónoma de Nuevo León — Faculty of Physics and Mathematics · 2002–2006

CLIENTS & ORGANIZATIONS

- CEMEX
- NEMAK
- VITRO
- Grupo AIE
- Fibra Inn
- Pueblo Bonito
- Papel San Francisco
- SADM
- Mega Alimentos
- Peñafiel
- HEINEKEN
- Minera México

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Data & Analytics leader and SAP data architect with a **business mindset** and **20+ years** of experience. I lead multidisciplinary teams and critical migrations that turn data into **measurable decisions and tangible savings**, across industry, consumer goods, hospitality and government. Today I lead the Data Engineering SAP team and data architecture at HEINEKEN Mexico, driving the **SAP-Databricks integration**.

20+

Years of experience

€1.5M

Economic value generated

~15

Professionals led

-50%

SAC licensing savings

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

SAP BW/4HANA · SAC Architect — HEINEKEN Mexico2019 – Present

I lead the Data Engineering SAP team and the analytics architecture, driving the **SAP-Databricks** convergence toward AI-augmented analytics.

- Built **Genie Sales Assistant** on Databricks AI/BI Genie: sales insights in **natural language**, without waiting for a report.
- Designed the **sales data product**: data extracted from SAP ECC and modeled in Databricks to automate daily OpCo-level tracking.
- SAC → Analysis for Office** redesign: **-50% in licensing cost** (2024 and 2025).
- Leading a **~15-person team**: **300+ reports** migrated to SAC.
- Critical **BW/4HANA 2023** and SAP Data Intelligence migrations delivered smoothly; **-50%** database storage and **-33%** application servers (DVM).
- SAP BO → SAC migration with planning-license optimization.

Sr. SAP BW Consultant — Grupo AIE2018 – 2019

- BW solutions for Nielsen indicators (Scantrack), Picture of Success (profitability) and Human Resources on BW on HANA.

BI/BPC Technical Lead · Project Manager — Grupo Pueblo Bonito2016 – 2018

- End-to-end financial consolidation, hotel operations reporting (P&L), IFRS and a Mobile solution; project management for FI/CO/MM, Supplier Portal and Electronic Accounting.

SAP BPC Technical Lead · Senior BW — Fibra Inn2015 – 2017

- Hotel operations budget planning and BI development for financial modules, BMV reporting and a Mobile solution.

Senior SAP BW Consultant — CEMEX2014 – 2015

- Profitability models (Mexico and Colombia), legal/overdue receivables and HR indicators integrating SAP and non-SAP sources.

CASE STUDIES · HEINEKEN MEXICO — D&C SOLUTIONS

Three stories where data architecture translated into decisions, savings and new capabilities.

Genie Sales Assistant: sales insights in natural language

From SAP–Databricks integration to AI-augmented analytics: a **governed sales data product** and an assistant that answers in natural language.

THE CHALLENGE

Daily OpCo-level sales tracking relied on fragmented reports and processes. Sales data lived in SAP ECC, far from modern analytics capabilities, and getting a concrete answer meant waiting for someone to build a report.

THE APPROACH

- ◆ Extraction of sales data from **SAP ECC** and modeling it as a governed **data product** in Databricks.
- ◆ Automation of **daily OpCo-level sales tracking** on top of that data product.
- ◆ Built **Genie Sales Assistant** on **Databricks AI/BI Genie**, answering business questions in **natural language**.

RESULTS

Natural language

Sales insights without waiting for a report

SAP ECC → Databricks

Governed sales data product

Daily · OpCo

Automated sales tracking

AI/BI Genie

AI-augmented generative analytics

SAP analytics platform modernization

Consolidating and modernizing the entire SAP analytics platform: critical migrations, licensing optimization and leadership of a **~15-person team**.

THE CHALLENGE

Analytics ran on a legacy SAP landscape, with scattered reporting and a high SAC licensing cost. Sustaining growth required consolidating the platform, modernizing base versions and standardizing executive reporting.

THE APPROACH

- ◆ **SAC → Analysis for Office** redesign with license optimization: **–50% in licensing cost**.
- ◆ Migration of **300+ reports** to SAC, standardizing executive reporting.
- ◆ Critical **BW/4HANA 2023** and **SAP Data Intelligence** migrations delivered smoothly.
- ◆ **SAP BO → SAC** migration with planning-license optimization.

RESULTS

–50%

Licensing cost (SAC → Analysis for Office)

300+

Reports migrated to SAC

~15

People on the team led

BW/4HANA 2023

Critical migration delivered smoothly

Data intelligence for manufacturing: €1.5M of value

The multi-plant operation managed fragmented supply contracts; we moved it from manual, reactive management to **full, proactive control**.

THE CHALLENGE

The multi-plant operation managed its supply contracts in a fragmented, manual way. Without a unified view, control was reactive and contractual coverage hard to standardize.

THE APPROACH

- ◆ Designed a tool that **unifies and standardizes** the entire supply-contract process.
- ◆ Moved from manual, reactive management to **full, proactive control**, with standardized annual contractual coverage.
- ◆ All achieved with **no additional infrastructure investment**.

RESULTS

€1.5M

Total economic value generated

€1.4M

Direct savings

€100k

Costs avoided

€0

Additional infrastructure investment